
Improving Long-Range Graph Propagation with MPSSM Based Preconditioning

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Abstract

We propose MPSSM-PCG, a learned preconditioner for graph-structured linear systems based on MPSSM [6]. We evaluate the method as a preconditioner for PCG and as a learned long-range propagation operator for shallow GCNs. On graph-derived systems, MPSSM-PCG achieves convergence results comparable to NeuralIF[12] while requiring substantially lower setup time. In addition, we show that the learned operator improves long-range propagation on ECHO-SSSP, allowing shallow GCNs to match or outperform deeper local GCNs. Code is provided in <https://github.com/MohamadCS/MPSSM-PCG>.

1 Introduction

Graph neural networks [11] are a very powerful tool for learning on graphs. They differ from standard MLP in that they mix node representations according to the graph structure, which makes them viable for graph based application.

In particular, message-passing neural networks (MPNN) [9] have received substantial attention over the last decade. MPNN layer updates node representations by aggregating information from neighbor nodes followed by a feature update (such as MLP).

While MPNN are effective for propagating local graph information, global information propagation remain challenging. For information to travel between nodes that are k -hops apart, a local MPNN generally requires at least k propagation layers. However, repeated propagation arises two main challenges in GNN: oversmoothing and oversquashing [1].

Oversmoothing [1] happens when a GNN based network stacks many MPNN layers, in which repeated averaging smooths node embeddings, and as a result they become very similar.

Oversquashing [1] When we repeatedly apply MPNN layers to node signals, an exponential amount of information needs to pass through a fixed size embedding vector.

Our goal is to design a shallow MPNN that uses a global propagation matrix for implicit long-range propagation, which allows us to achieve long-range propagation with fewer MPNN layers. To do that, we use a global propagation matrix like $(I + \alpha L)^{-1}$ (see appendix) to replace the local propagation matrix (often normalized adjacency matrix).

However, the inverse of sparse matrices like $I + \alpha L$ usually dense, which makes it harder to construct and apply.

To address this, we learn an efficient operator to invert $M_\theta \approx I + \alpha L$. This allows us to approximate the effect of applying the global propagation operator, without the need of explicitly computing it. This provides both long-range feature propagation and the efficiency of shallow MPNNs.

In this paper, we design a preconditioning model called MPSSM-PCG based on MPSSM [6], and use it to precondition the global operator $I + \alpha L$.

1.1 Problem Setup

Preconditioning Given an SPD linear system $Kx = b$, a preconditioner is a matrix $P \approx K^{-1}$ that is efficient to apply. Ideally we require the preconditioned system to satisfy $\kappa(PK) \ll \kappa(K)$, where κ denotes the condition number. In SPD settings, this corresponds to better clustering of the eigenvalues of the preconditioned system, which accelerates the convergence of iterative solvers like PCG.

In our settings, instead of learning P directly we learn an easily invertible approximation $M_\theta(K) \approx K$ and define $P_\theta(K) = M_\theta(K)^{-1} \approx K^{-1}$.

We use the parametrization $M_\theta = L_\theta L_\theta^\top$ where L_θ follows the IC(0) sparsity pattern (Eq.6).

Shallow Long-Range MPNN Given a graph $\mathcal{G} = (\mathcal{V}, \mathcal{E})$, denote its adjacency matrix by A , where $A_{ij} = A_{ji} = \mathbb{I}[(i, j) \in \mathcal{E}]$, and its normalized laplacian matrix by $L = I - D^{-1/2} A D^{-1/2}$. Considering the operator $K = I + \alpha L$, our goal is to learn an efficient operator to invert $M_\theta(K) \approx K$ so that using shallow MPNN layer 1 with $P_\theta(K) = M_\theta^{-1}(K)$ as its shift operator

$$Y = \sigma(P_\theta(K)XW) \quad (1)$$

approximates long-range propagation. Here W is a learnable feature mixing matrix, σ is a non-linear activation function and X contains the node signals.

2 Related Work

2.1 Long Range Propagation

Attention Based Method Transformers [19] model the dependencies between feature sequence using self-attention mechanism. Graph nodes can be represented as a sequence of tokens, such that the computed attention matrix is treated like a new weighted adjacency matrix. The problem with this approach is that the transformer is not aware of the graph structure. Works like Graphormer [20] use positional and structural embeddings to inject the graph structure. GraphGPS [17] computes global attention to learn dependencies between distant nodes, and uses a local MPNN to learn dependencies between nearby nodes.

Implicit GNN [2, 3] IGNN achieve long-range propagation by solving the equilibrium equation $X = f_\theta(X, A)$, where A is the adjacency matrix and X are the node signals. For instance, the original IGNN model [10] finds X such that $X = \sigma(WXA + b)$. They solve it by repeatedly applying the equation using the same learned weight matrices until convergence, allowing information to propagate through long distances without the need for deep propagation.

2.2 Learning Preconditioners

[13] learns a preconditioner $P = f_\theta(A, b)$ for the discretized PDE linear system $Ax = b$. They treat A as an adjacency matrix, having A_{ij} as an edge feature and b_i as a node feature. They encode the graph into a hidden representation using MLP encoder, then they follow it by multiple MPNN layers and pass into a decoder that predicts a matrix M that is used to construct the preconditioner P . In order to guarantee symmetry they learn $LL^\top$.

[4] constructs a two-layer sparse linear neural network whose weights are the entries of the incomplete Cholesky factor L with fixed sparsity pattern. The first layer applies $L^\top$ while the second applies L .

[12] learns a lower-triangular matrix $L_\theta(A)$ with strictly positive diagonal, where the final preconditioner becomes $L_\theta(A)L_\theta^\top(A)$. They do that by firstly propagating information using MPNN layers of the lower-triangular part of A , then they do the same with the upper triangular part of A . Finally the edge embeddings become the entries of a sparse matrix triangular factor.

[7] uses a GCN based method for learning a network M that acts as an approximation to the inverse. They do that by first scaling the input vector b and pass it into an encoder for a hidden representation, then they pass it into multiple GCN layers, decode it back to its original dimension and rescale it.

Most methods we’ve looked at directly learn a preconditioner. [18] proposed to use GNNs to learn a correction for the given matrix. Given a lower triangular IC factor L of A , their goal is to learn $L(\theta) = L + \alpha \text{GNN}(\theta, L)$. They use simple encoding, propagation using MPNN and decoding back.

Algebraic multigrids (AMG) are also used for learning preconditioners. AMG constructs a hierarchy of coarse representations directly from the given matrix. [15] uses GNN based architecture to learn the prolongation weights between the coarse and fine levels. [14] combined algebraic multigrid principles with a transformer based architecture to learn a multi-scale preconditioning operator.

[5] learns a fixed pattern sparse approximation inverse $M = GG^\top$. The difference with from other methods is that they minimize spectral objectives of M rather than Frobenius norm.

3 Method

Given the system $K = I + \alpha L$, we define the sparsity pattern of K as $(A_s)_{ij} = \mathbb{I}[K_{ij} \neq 0]$, $(D_s)_{ii} = \sum_j (A_s)_{ij}$, and the propagation operator

$$S = D_s^{-1/2} A_s D_s^{-1/2}$$

For each matrix row i we construct the feature vector

$$u_i = \left[\frac{K_{ii}}{s}, \frac{\sum_{i \neq j} |K_{ij}|}{s}, \frac{d_i}{\bar{d}}, p_i \right] \quad (2)$$

where $s = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n |K_{ii}|$ and $\bar{d} = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n d_i$ when d_i is the number of nonzero off-diagonal entries in row i and $p_i \in [-1, 1]$ is the normalized row position.

We combine the feature vectors $\{u_i\}$ to construct the feature matrix $U = [u_1, \dots, u_n]^\top \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times 4}$.

MPSSM We use MPSSM [6] as our backbone for learning the matrix L_θ as it gives a natural way of separating S and U . For an MPSSM block, we initialize the hidden state as $X_0 = 0$, and update it for T recurrent step according to

$$X_{t+1} = S X_t W + U B \quad t = 0, \dots, T-1$$

The same input projection UB is injected at every recurrent step and W is shared across all steps of the block. After the final recurrence we apply

$$Z = \text{MLP}(X_T) \quad (3)$$

We stack B MPSSM blocks. The first block operates on U

$$H^{(1)} = \text{GraphNorm}(\text{MPSSM}_1(S, U)) \quad (4)$$

and

$$H^{(l)} = \text{GraphNorm}(H^{(l-1)} + \text{MPSSM}^{(l-1)}(S, H^{(l-1)})) \quad (5)$$

This results in $H = H^{(B)}$ which will be used to predict L_θ .

Incomplete Factorization Prediction Similar to [12] we restrict the lower-triangular part of L_θ (excluding the diagonal) to the IC(0) sparsity pattern

$$E_0 = \{(i, j) | i > j, K_{ij} \neq 0\} \quad (6)$$

For every $(i, j) \in E_0$ we construct the edge feature

$$e_{ij} = \left[H_i \|H_j\| \frac{K_{ij}}{s} \right] \quad (7)$$

and predict

$$(L_\theta)_{ij} = \text{MLP}_{\text{edge}}(e_{ij}) \quad (8)$$

We predict the diagonal independly. To guarantee the the diagonal is postive, we use the transformation

$$(L_\theta)_{ii} = \exp(c \cdot \text{MLP}_{\text{diag}}(H_i)) \quad (9)$$

where c is a constant¹.

Now since L_θ is a lower triagonal matrix with strictly positive diagonal we get $M_\theta = L_\theta L_\theta^\top$ is a PD matrix and hence invertable and can be used for PCG.

Training Our training method is similar to [14, 12]. Instead of directly minimizing the objective $\|K - L_\theta L_\theta^\top\|_F^2$, which can be quite expensive as the matrix dimesntions increase, we sample k random vectors $x_i \sim \mathcal{N}(0, I)$, construct the matrix $X = [x_1, \dots, x_k]$ and minimize

$$\mathcal{L} = \frac{\|KX - L_\theta L_\theta^\top X\|_F^2}{\|KX\|_F^2} \quad (10)$$

Preconditioned Graph Propagation We achive long-range propgation by using the global operator $K^{-1} = (I + \alpha L)^{-1}$ as our propagation operator. We firstly approximate K using MPSSM-PCG and obtain the incomplete factorization $M_\theta = L_\theta L_\theta^\top \approx K$, then define the propagation opertor as $P_\theta = M_\theta^{-1}$ and plug it into a conventional GCN layer

$$H^{(l+1)} = \sigma(P_\theta H^{(l)} W^{(l)})$$

Refer to appendix (6) for GCN architcture details

4 Evaluation

4.1 Experiment Setup

Our evaluation consists of two parts. First we directly evaluate the model as a preconditioner for solving graph-structured linear equations using preconditioned conjugate gradient (PCG (1)). Second, we use the learned preconditioning operator as a propagation operator of a shallow GCN and evaluate whether it improves long-range propagation on long-range graph learning tasks.

For a graph $\mathcal{G}$ we construct the system $K = I + \alpha L$, where $L = I - D^{-1/2} A D^{-1/2}$ is the normalized laplacian, and $\alpha > 0$ (see A) controls the effective propagation range .

Preconditioning Training Both MPSSM-PCG and NeuralIF are trained under the same protocol. We train the models using the objective in Eq.10 with 10 Gaussian probes per matrix and evaluate the best validation checkpoint on the test split. At test time, each unseen system is solved 5 times using indepenedly generated RHS. We terminate PCG when $\|r\|_2 / \|b\|_2 < \text{tol} = 10^{-6}$ or after 1000 iterations. Refer to the appendix for per expirement hyperparameters.

Long-range Propagation After training MPSSM-PCG on a dataset. We freeze MPSSM-PCG’s parameters. Then, we train two identical conventional GCN models, that only differ in the propagation matrix. One time we train with $\hat{A}$, and the other with P_θ . For ECHO-SSSP [16], both models are trained using MSE (Eq.15) and selected according to valdiation MAE (Eq.17) at best validation checkpoint. Refer to the appendix for per expirement hyperparameters.

Note that we do each expirement 3 times using the seeds $\{0, 1, 2\}$.

¹We found that having an indepenent decoder for the diagonal is more numerically stable

4.2 Preconditioner Performance

We first evaluate the quality of the preconditioner through its effect on the convergence of PCG. MPSSM-PCG is compared against NeuralIF, Jacobi and the unpreconditioned identity baseline. For each test system, we sample $x \sim \mathcal{N}(0, I)$, $b = Kx$ which provides the exact solution for evaluating both convergence and solution accuracy. Instead of directly constructing M_θ^{-1} , we apply the preconditioner in two steps $L_\theta y = r$ then $L_\theta^\top z = y$. Complete residual and solution-error statistics are provided in the appendix.

Table 1: Preconditioning performance on ECHO-SSSP graph systems using the operator $K = I + 8L$. Methods are evaluated on their PCG performance on unseen test system. Results are averaged over three seeds $\{0, 1, 2\}$. Time units are in ms.

Method	Conv. % $\uparrow$	PCG Iteration $\downarrow$	Setup Time $\downarrow$	Solve Time $\downarrow$	Total Time $\downarrow$
Identity	100% $\pm$ 0.0	21.86 $\pm$ 0.00	0.001 $\pm$ 0.000	2.225 $\pm$ 0.011	2.225 $\pm$ 0.011
Jacobi	100% $\pm$ 0.0	21.50 $\pm$ 0.00	0.008 $\pm$ 0.001	2.240 $\pm$ 0.010	2.249 $\pm$ 0.010
NeuralIF	100% $\pm$ 0.0	8.73 $\pm$ 0.02	0.722 $\pm$ 0.001	1.587 $\pm$ 0.007	2.309 $\pm$ 0.005
MPSSM-PCG	100% $\pm$ 0.0	8.93 $\pm$ 0.03	0.274 $\pm$ 0.007	1.636 $\pm$ 0.004	1.910 $\pm$ 0.004

The results show that both NeuralIF and MPSSM-PCG substantially reduce the number of PCG iterations compared with classical preconditioners in PCG iteration count. NeuralIF achieves slightly lower iteration count than MPSSM-PCG. However MPSSM-PCG has approximately 62% lower setup time (C.4) than NeuralIF, resulting in approximately 17% reduction in the total time (C.4). We see very similar results using Peptides graphs [8] (See table 9 in appendix).

4.3 Long-Range Propagation Performance

Next we evaluate whether the learned preconditioner can be used as an effective long-range propagation operator in a shallow graph neural network.

Table 2: Effect of the propagation parameter α on ECHO-SSSP. The table shows the test MAE for and PGCN per α value. PGCN uses 1 layer for propagation.

α	PGCN MAE $\downarrow$
1.0	0.1255 $\pm$ 0.000571
2.0	0.1174 $\pm$ 0.000126
4.0	0.1106 $\pm$ 0.000609
8.0	0.1070 $\pm$ 0.000488

In table (2) we perform simple ablation to evaluate the effect of the propagation parameter α . As established by (A), increasing α increases the effective propagation range of $(I + \alpha L)^{-1}$. Therefore we expect that larger values of α to be beneficial on long-range benchmarks like ECHO-SSSP [16]. The results shown in 2 is consistent with this interpretation, as the test MAE decreases as α increases. We can also notice diminishing returns past $\alpha = 4$.

Table 3: Depth comparison on ECHO-SSSP. The table shows the test MAE for local GCN and PGCN at different propagation depths. PGCN uses a learned preconditioning operator with $\alpha = 8.0$.

Layers	Local GCN MAE $\downarrow$	PGCN MAE $\downarrow$
1	0.1421 $\pm$ 0.000030	0.1070 $\pm$ 0.000488
2	0.1321 $\pm$ 0.000091	0.0846 $\pm$ 0.000891
4	0.1112 $\pm$ 0.000242	0.0791 $\pm$ 0.001215
8	0.0748 $\pm$ 0.000437	0.0684 $\pm$ 0.001254

In the second experiment we evaluate the effect of replacing the local propagation operator $\hat{A}$ with the learned operator P_θ . As shown in 3, PGCN achieves substantially better performance with less layers. A one layer of PGCN achieves an MAE of 0.107 while outperforming four layers of local GCN that achieved MAE of 0.111. As depth increases the local GCN substantially improves and closes the gap, however PGCN still outperforms it at every depth.

5 Conclusion

We introduced MPSSM-PCG, a learned preconditioner for graph-structured linear systems based on MPSSM. MPSSM-PCG achieves preconditioning quality comparable to an existing learned preconditioner while requiring substantially lower setup time. Furthermore, we showed that the learned operator $P_\theta \approx (I + \alpha L)^{-1}$ can be used as a long-range graph propagation operator. The learned operator substantially improves the performance of shallow GCNs enabling long-range propagation to be achieved using fewer layers.

5.1 Limitations

Main limitation arises from our limited computation budget. First, the multilayer long-range propagation in table 3 is conducted using a single value of α , so evaluating the relation between propagation depth and α more extensively could provide a better image of the effect of the learned operator.

Second, we considered operators of the form $I + \alpha L$ only. Other long-range graph operators like e^{-tL} , $L^\dagger$ could also be considered, as they could be more suitable for different graph-learning tasks.

Finally MPSSM-PCG is specifically designed around graph-structured sparse systems and was evaluated on systems computed from graph-learning datasets. Its effectiveness on more general sparse SPD matrices remains to be investigated.

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A Interpretation of $(I + \alpha L)^{-1}$

Throughout the paper we have used $K^{-1} = (I + \alpha L)^{-1}$ as our long-range propagation operator. We now show mathematically that K^{-1} indeed does multi-hop propagation of the normalized adjacency matrix $\hat{A}$.

Notice that $K = I + \alpha L = (1 + \alpha)I - \alpha \hat{A}$ and so using Neumann expansion

$$K^{-1} = \frac{1}{1 + \alpha} \left(I - \frac{\alpha}{1 + \alpha} \hat{A} \right)^{-1} = \frac{1}{1 + \alpha} \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \left(\frac{\alpha}{1 + \alpha} \right)^k \hat{A}^k \quad (11)$$

The usage of Neumann expansion is valid since for $\alpha > 0$

$$\rho \left(\frac{\alpha}{1 + \alpha} \hat{A} \right) = \frac{\alpha}{1 + \alpha} \rho(\hat{A}) \leq \frac{\alpha}{1 + \alpha} < 1 \quad (12)$$

A conventional GCN layer propagates using $\hat{A}$

$$H^{(l+1)} = \sigma(\hat{A}H^{(l)}W^{(l)})$$

This only does 1-hop propagation.

Replacing $\hat{A}$ with K^{-1} is equivalent to

$$H^{(l+1)} = \sigma(K^{-1}H^{(l)}W^{(l)}) = \sigma \left(\frac{1}{1 + \alpha} \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \left(\frac{\alpha}{1 + \alpha} \right)^k \hat{A}^k H^{(l)}W^{(l)} \right)$$

Define

$$w_k = \frac{1}{1 + \alpha} \left(\frac{\alpha}{1 + \alpha} \right)^k \quad (13)$$

Notice that larger α corresponds to slower weight decay. Therefore we can achieve longer effective propagation by increasing α .

B Additional Method Details

B.1 PCG Algorithm

Algorithm 1 Preconditioned Conjugate Gradient

Require: SPD Matrix A , RHS b , preconditioner P , initial guess x_0 , tolerance ϵ , maximum iterations K

```

1:  $x \leftarrow x_0$ 
2:  $r \leftarrow b - Ax$ 
3:  $z \leftarrow P(r)$ 
4:  $p \leftarrow z$ 
5: for  $k = 0, \dots, K - 1$  do
6:    $q \leftarrow Ap$ 
7:    $r' \leftarrow \langle r, z \rangle$ 
8:    $\alpha \leftarrow \frac{r'}{\langle p, q \rangle}$ 
9:    $x \leftarrow x + \alpha p$ 
10:   $r \leftarrow r - \alpha q$ 
11:  if  $\frac{\|r\|_2}{\|b\|_2} < \epsilon$  then
12:    return  $x$ 
13:  end if
14:   $z \leftarrow P(r)$ 
15:   $\beta \leftarrow \frac{\langle r, z \rangle}{r'}$ 
16:   $p \leftarrow z + \beta p$ 
17: end for
18: return  $x$ 

```

B.2 MPSSM-PCG implementation

Algorithm 2 MPSSM Block

Require: Propagation matrix S , Matrix Features U , SSM steps T

```

1:  $X_0 \leftarrow \mathbf{0}$ 
2: for  $s = 0, \dots, T - 1$  do
3:    $X_{s+1} \leftarrow SX_sW + UB$ 
4: end for
5: return  $\text{MLP}(X_T)$ 

```

Algorithm 3 MPSSM

Require: Propagation matrix S , Matrix Features U , SSM steps T , SSM Blocks B , Dropout p

```

1:  $H_0 \leftarrow \text{GraphNorm}(\text{MPSSM}_0(U, S))$ 
2: for  $b = 0, \dots, B - 1$  do
3:    $H_{b+1} \leftarrow \text{GraphNorm}(H_b + \text{Dropout}_p(\text{MPSSM}_b(H_b, S)))$ 
4: end for
5: return  $H_B$ 

```

Algorithm 4 MPSSM-PCG

Require: System K

```
1:  $S \leftarrow D^{-1/2} A_S D^{-1/2}$   $\triangleright A_S$  is the sparisty pattern (Eq.6) of  $K$ 
2:  $U \leftarrow \text{matrix\_node\_features}(K)$   $\triangleright U = [u_1, \dots, u_n]^\top$  when  $u_i$  is defined as in Eq.2
3:  $H \leftarrow \text{MPSSM}(S, U)$ 
4:  $E_0 \leftarrow \{(i, j) | i > j, K_{ij} \neq 0\}$ 
5:  $L_\theta \leftarrow \mathbf{0}$ 
6: for all  $(i, j) \in E_0$  do
7:    $e_{ij} \leftarrow [H_i || H_j || K_{ij} / s]$ 
8:    $(L_\theta)_{ij} = \text{MLP}_{\text{edge}}(e_{ij})$ 
9: end for
10: for  $i = 1, \dots, n$  do
11:    $\delta_i \leftarrow \text{MLP}_{\text{diag}}(H_i)$ 
12:    $(L_\theta)_{ii} \leftarrow e^{c\delta_i}$   $\triangleright$  In our implementation  $c = 0.1$ 
13: end for
14: return  $L_\theta$ 
```

Algorithm 5 Apply MPSSM-PCG Preconditioner

Require: Sparse Factor L , Residual r

```
1:  $y \leftarrow \text{solve\_triangular}(L, r, \text{upper} = F)$   $\triangleright$  Pytorch's torch.linalg.solve_triangular
2:  $z \leftarrow \text{solve\_triangular}(L^\top, y, \text{upper} = T)$ 
3: return  $z$ 
```

B.3 GCN Architicture

Algorithm 6 GCN For ECHO-SSSP

Require: Normalized adjecacny $\hat{A}$, Node Embeddings X , Layers L , Dropout p

```
1:  $H_0 \leftarrow \text{MLP}_{\text{encoder}}(X)$ 
2: for  $i = 0, \dots, L - 1$  do
3:    $R_t \leftarrow H_t$ 
4:    $H_t \leftarrow \text{ReLU}(\text{LayerNorm}(\hat{A}H_tW_t))$ 
5:    $H_t \leftarrow \text{Dropout}_p(H_t) + R_t$ 
6: end for
7: return  $\text{MLP}_{\text{out}}(H_L)$ 
```

Algorithm 7 PGCN For ECHO-SSSP

Require: Sparse Factor L_θ , Node Embeddings X , Layers L , Dropout p

```
1:  $H_0 \leftarrow \text{MLP}_{\text{encoder}}(X)$ 
2: for  $i = 0, \dots, L - 1$  do
3:    $R_t \leftarrow H_t$ 
4:    $H_t \leftarrow \text{ReLU}(\text{LayerNorm}(\text{apply}(L_\theta, H_t)W_t))$   $\triangleright$  When apply as in alg.5
5:    $H_t \leftarrow \text{Dropout}_p(H_t) + R_t$ 
6: end for
7: return  $\text{MLP}_{\text{out}}(H_L)$ 
```

C Evaluation

C.1 Hardware Configuration

We run all the tests on Ryzen 9600X CPU, 32GB of RAM and an AMD Radeon 9070 XT GPU with 16 GB of VRAM.

C.2 Software and Libraries

Specific libraries are provided using ‘requirements.txt’.

C.3 Experiments Hyperparameters

Table 4: Hyperparameters used in MPSSM-PCG ECHO-SSSP/Peptides-struct preconditioning experiment

Hyperparameter	Value
Optimizer	Adam
Learning Rate	10^{-3}
Train Epochs	50
Checkpoint Selection	Best Validation loss
Hidden Dimesntion	16
Blocks	2
Steps	4
Normalization	GraphNorm
Dropout	0

Table 5: NeuralIF Hyperparameters ECHO-SSSP/Peptides-struct preconditioning experiment

Hyperparameter	Value
Optimizer	Adam
Learning Rate	10^{-3}
Train Epochs	50
Checkpoint Selection	Best Validation loss
message_passing_steps	4
global_features Dimesntion	0
latent_size	8
skip_connections	True
activation	ReLU
aggregate	None
decode_nodes	False
normalize_diag	False
graph_norm	True
two_hop	False
edge_features	1

This configuration is the closest configuration to what the authors of NeuralIF [12] chose. We just used 4 message passing steps instead of 3 to have a close parameter count to ours.

Table 6: Hyperparameters used in MPSSM-PCG ECHO-SSSP experiment

Hyperparameter	Value
Optimizer	Adam
Learning Rate	10^{-4}
Train Epochs	30
Checkpoint Selection	Best Validation loss
Hidden Dimesntion	16
Blocks	2
Steps	4
Normalization	GraphNorm
Dropout	0

Table 7: GCN hyperparameters for ECHO-SSSP long-range propagation experiments

Hyperparameter	Value
Optimizer	Adam
Learning Rate	10^{-5}
Train Epochs	300
Checkpoint Selection	Best Validation loss
Hidden Dimenstion	384
Normalization	LayerNorm
Dropout	0.1

GCN layers used in the experiments are stated in each table.

The total parameter count of MPSSM-PCG is 2594 while NeuralIF is 2488.

C.4 Metrics

Setup time Measures the cost of constructing the preconditioner for a unseen system K . For MPSSM-PCG, this consists of constructing the matrix representation, running the MPSSM encoder and decoding L_θ . Similarly, for NeuralIF this is the forward pass for constructing L_θ . Preconditioning training is not part of the setup time.

Since the tested preconditioners only rely on K , for each graph we sample $N_{rhs} = 5$ random RHS and reuse the computed preconditioner to solve the 5 systems, so the actual setup time presented in tables is

$$t_{setup} = \frac{t_{\text{preconditioner construction}}}{N_{rhs}} \quad (14)$$

Solve Time Measures the execution time of PCG 1 and the applications of the preconditioner. MPSSM-PCG and NeuralIF preconditioners are applied using 5.

Total Time The sum of the setup time and solve time.

Mean Squared Error For a graph G with predictions $\hat{\mathbf{y}}$ and targets $\mathbf{y}$ containing N targets

$$\text{MSE}(G) = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N (y_i - \hat{y}_i)^2 \quad (15)$$

for a mini batch B

$$\text{MSE}(B) = \frac{1}{|B|} \sum_{G \in B} \text{MSE}(G) \quad (16)$$

Mean Absolute Error

$$\text{MAE} = \frac{\sum_G \sum_{v \in V_G} |y_v - \hat{y}_v|}{\sum_G |V_G|} \quad (17)$$

During training, the training loss gives equal weights to each graph (regardless of the number of nodes). In evaluation MAE give equal weight to each target node.

C.5 Additional Experiments

In addition to Tabel 1 we include both the relative residual

$$\frac{\|b - K\hat{x}\|_2}{\|b\|_2} \quad (18)$$

and the relative solution error

$$\frac{\|x - \hat{x}\|_2}{\|x\|_2} \quad (19)$$

Table 8: Preconditioning performance on ECHO-SSSP graph systems. Methods are evaluated on their PCG performance on unseen test system. Results are averaged over three seeds $\{0, 1, 2\}$.

Method	Rel. Error $\downarrow$	Rel. Residual $\downarrow$
Identity	$2.094 \cdot 10^{-6} \pm 2.305 \cdot 10^{-9}$	$7.410 \cdot 10^{-7} \pm 1.065 \cdot 10^{-9}$
Jacobi	$2.112 \cdot 10^{-6} \pm 7.335 \cdot 10^{-9}$	$7.348 \cdot 10^{-7} \pm 1.985 \cdot 10^{-9}$
NeuralIF	$1.286 \cdot 10^{-6} \pm 6.873 \cdot 10^{-9}$	$4.725 \cdot 10^{-7} \pm 1.534 \cdot 10^{-9}$
MPSSM-PCG (ours)	$1.289 \cdot 10^{-6} \pm 1.076 \cdot 10^{-8}$	$4.725 \cdot 10^{-7} \pm 2.207 \cdot 10^{-9}$

Table 9: Preconditioning performance on peptides-struct graph systems $K = I + 8L$, with 2000/500/500 split. Methods are evaluated on their PCG performance on unseen test system. Results are averaged over three seeds $\{0, 1, 2\}$. Timing are presented in ms.

Method	Conv. % $\uparrow$	PCG Iteration $\downarrow$	Setup Time (ms) $\downarrow$	Solve Time (ms) $\downarrow$	Total Time (ms) $\downarrow$
Identity	100.0 ± 0.0	21.90 ± 0.00	0.001 ± 0.000	2.244 ± 0.002	2.245 ± 0.002
Jacobi	100.0 ± 0.0	21.64 ± 0.01	0.009 ± 0.002	2.266 ± 0.004	2.275 ± 0.006
NeuralIF	100.0 ± 0.0	9.00 ± 0.01	0.732 ± 0.005	1.947 ± 0.064	2.679 ± 0.062
MPSSMPCG	100.0 ± 0.0	9.23 ± 0.02	0.299 ± 0.004	2.015 ± 0.053	2.314 ± 0.052

Table 10: Preconditioning performance on peptides-struct graph systems with 2000/500/500 split. Methods are evaluated on their PCG performance on unseen test system. Results are averaged over three seeds $\{0, 1, 2\}$.

Method	Rel. Error $\downarrow$	Rel. Residual $\downarrow$
Identity	$2.220 \cdot 10^{-6} \pm 5.722 \cdot 10^{-9}$	$7.815 \cdot 10^{-7} \pm 1.628 \cdot 10^{-9}$
Jacobi	$2.031 \cdot 10^{-6} \pm 3.599 \cdot 10^{-9}$	$6.932 \cdot 10^{-7} \pm 1.051 \cdot 10^{-9}$
NeuralIF	$1.679 \cdot 10^{-6} \pm 8.283 \cdot 10^{-9}$	$6.393 \cdot 10^{-7} \pm 4.363 \cdot 10^{-9}$
MPSSMPCG	$1.602 \cdot 10^{-6} \pm 2.746 \cdot 10^{-8}$	$5.961 \cdot 10^{-7} \pm 6.647 \cdot 10^{-9}$